

psychtools — LaTeX Macros for Psychology
Manuscripts
Version 1.0

Ansgar Endress
ansgar.endress@gmx.net

2026/06/26

Contents

1	Introduction	1
2	Package Options	2
3	Statistical Notation	3
4	Supplementary Materials and Appendix	3
4.1	\myappendix	4
4.2	\appsection{<title>}	4
4.3	\appsectionFirst{<title>} (deprecated)	5
4.4	\appendixshortname	5
5	Draft Editing Aids	5
5.1	Draft section headings	5
5.2	\footnotewithdetails{<text>}	6
5.3	\colorize{<text>}	6
6	Citation Helpers (apacite)	6
7	Miscellaneous	6
7.1	\includesubgraphics{<label>}{<filename>}	6
7.2	\protectedemail{<address>}	7
8	Backward Compatibility	7
9	License	7
A	Command and Option Reference	7

1 Introduction

`psychtools` provides a collection of convenience macros for writing empirical psychology and cognitive science manuscripts in L^AT_EX. It addresses four common needs:

- **Statistical notation** (§3): compact, italic commands for standard test statistics and effect sizes, matching APA formatting requirements.
- **Supplementary-materials appendix** (§4): automatic S-prefixed numbering for pages, sections, figures, and tables, with an optional local table of contents.
- **Draft editing aids** (§5): footnotes and section headers that are marked for removal are shown in red during writing but can be hidden entirely for the final submission by switching a single package option.
- **Citation shortcuts** (§6): two helpers for `apacite` users.

Load the package in the usual way:

```
\usepackage{psychtools}  
% or with options:  
\usepackage[excludedetails,appendixtoc]{psychtools}
```

`psychtools` requires `tocloft`, `xcolor`, `subcaption`, `xspace`, and `tikz`, all of which are part of standard T_EX Live and MikT_EX distributions.

A self-contained worked example (`howto.tex` / `howto.pdf`) is distributed alongside this documentation. It illustrates every command and option using a simulated serial-position-effect free-recall experiment.

2 Package Options

`psychtools` declares five options, described below. Where a default is listed the option is active unless you explicitly override it; options with no default are inactive unless you request them.

`includedetails` / `excludedetails` **(default: `includedetails`)**

These two options control the visibility of *draft content* — footnotes and section headers that are intended to remind the author of outstanding work and that should be removed before final submission. Draft content is produced by `\footnotewithdetails`, `\draftsection`, `\draftsubsection`, and `\draftsubsubsection` (see §5).

With the default `includedetails`, draft content appears in the output (coloured red unless `nocolorize` is also given). Switch to `excludedetails` when preparing the submission copy: all draft content disappears silently, with no extra blank space or other artefact.

appendxtoc (default: off)

When `appendxtoc` is active, `psychtools` suppresses supplementary-materials entries from the *main* document table of contents and instead prints a separate, local TOC immediately after the supplementary-materials header produced by `\myappendix` (see §4).

Without this option, supplementary sections appear in the main document TOC normally.

nocolorize (default: off)

By default, draft content is typeset in red so it is easy to distinguish from the main text during writing. Passing `nocolorize` suppresses the colouring: draft content is shown in the normal text colour. This option also affects `\colorize` (see §7).

nocitecommands (default: off)

Disables the `apacite` citation helpers `\citeeg` and `\cites` (see §6). Use this option if you are not using `apacite` and wish to define these command names yourself.

3 Statistical Notation

The commands in Table 1 typeset common test statistics and effect sizes in italic math style, matching APA formatting requirements. Each command includes a trailing `\xspace` so it can be used freely in running text without extra braces.

Example

The effect was significant, $T(38) = 2.45$, $p = .019$, $D = 0.77$.

Produces: The effect was significant, $t(38) = 2.45$, $p = .019$, Cohen’s $d = 0.77$.

Compatibility warning The short command names (`\T`, `\F`, `\Z`, `\p`, `\M`, `\U`, `\W`) may conflict with commands defined by math or font packages. To minimise the risk, load `psychtools` *before* any math-heavy packages. If you encounter a “command already defined” error, identify which other package

Command	Output	Meaning
<code>\T</code>	t	Student's t
<code>\F</code>	F	F ratio
<code>\Z</code>	Z	Z score
<code>\p</code>	p	p value
<code>\M</code>	M	Mean
<code>\SD</code>	SD	Standard deviation
<code>\SE</code>	SE	Standard error
<code>\D</code>	Cohen's d	Cohen's d
<code>\CI</code>	$CI_{.95}$	95% confidence interval
<code>\et</code>	η^2	Eta-squared
<code>\etp</code>	η_p^2	Partial eta-squared
<code>\U</code>	U	Mann–Whitney U
<code>\W</code>	W	Wilcoxon W

Table 1: Statistical notation commands.

defines the conflicting name and either reorder the `\usepackage` declarations or stop loading that package.

4 Supplementary Materials and Appendix

Many psychology journals require supplementary materials to use a distinct numbering scheme: pages are labelled **S1**, **S2**, ..., and figures and tables carry the prefix **S** (e.g. Figure S1, Table S3). Setting this up manually requires resetting multiple L^AT_EX counters and renewing several formatting commands. `psychtools` encapsulates all of this in a single call.

4.1 `\myappendix`

Place `\myappendix` at the point in your document where the supplementary materials begin. It performs the following actions automatically:

- resets the page counter to 1 and formats it as **S1**, **S2**, ...;
- resets the section counter to 0 and prefixes section numbers with the *short name* derived from `\appendixname` (see below);
- resets the figure and table counters to 0 and prefixes their numbers with **S**;
- prints a large bold heading containing `\appendixname`;
- if the `appendixtoc` option is active, adjusts TOC indentation for the longer prefixes and prints a local table of contents.

Setting the appendix name. You should set `\appendixname` in your document *before* calling `\myappendix`:

```
\renewcommand{\appendixname}{Supplementary Online Materials}
\myappendix
```

If `\appendixname` is not set, the language-dependent default (e.g. “Appendix” in English) is used and the prefix will be S. The following values produce a two-letter prefix via `\appendixshortname`:

<code>\appendixname</code>	Prefix
Supplementary Information	SI
Supplementary Materials	SM
Supplementary Online Materials	SM
anything else	S

4.2 `\appsection{<title>}`

Use `\appsection` for all sections inside the supplementary materials. It behaves like a regular `\section` with one important difference: from the *second* section onwards it automatically inserts a `\clearpage` before the new section heading, so that each supplementary section starts on a fresh page. The first section is not preceded by a page break (since `\myappendix` already ends with `\clearpage`).

This differs from a plain `\section`, which never inserts an automatic page break. Using `\section` inside the supplementary materials works, but you would need to insert `\clearpage` manually between sections.

```
\renewcommand{\appendixname}{Supplementary Online Materials}
\myappendix
\appsection{Stimuli}           % first section | no preceding page break
...
\appsection{Additional Analyses} % second section | preceded by \clearpage
...
```

4.3 `\appsectionFirst{<title>}` (deprecated)

An earlier version of `psychtools` required the *first* appendix section to be introduced with `\appsectionFirst` rather than `\appsection`, because the original `\appsection` unconditionally inserted a `\clearpage`. The current implementation of `\appsection` checks the section counter and skips the page break when it is zero, making `\appsectionFirst` a no-op alias. It is retained for backward compatibility; new documents should use `\appsection` throughout.

4.4 `\appendixshortname`

`\appendixshortname` expands to the short prefix (SI, SM, or S) used for section numbers. It is called internally by `\myappendix` but is available if you need the prefix elsewhere in your document.

5 Draft Editing Aids

During manuscript preparation it is common to keep reminders about content that still needs to be added or revised — for example, a section that is present only as a placeholder, or a footnote explaining a methodological choice that will be cut before submission. The commands in this section allow you to include such material in the source file while making it visually prominent (coloured red) and easy to remove: switching the `excludedetails` package option hides all draft content without leaving blank space or other artefacts.

5.1 Draft section headings

Command	Effect
<code>\draftsection{<t>}</code>	Typesets a <code>\section</code> heading with the prefix (Header will be removed) in red. The heading is invisible with <code>excludedetails</code> .
<code>\draftsubsection{<t>}</code>	Same for a <code>\subsection</code> heading.
<code>\draftsubsubsection{<t>}</code>	Same for a <code>\subsubsection</code> heading.

When the `appendixtoc` option is active, draft headings are automatically excluded from the supplementary-materials TOC.

5.2 `\footnotewithdetails{<text>}`

Inserts a footnote with the prefix (Footnote will be removed) in red, followed by `<text>`. The footnote is invisible with `excludedetails`. Use this for methodological notes or explanations that are helpful during review but should be cut from the final paper.

5.3 `\colorize{<text>}`

The primary use of `\colorize` is to mark passages that have been revised in response to reviewer comments, so that the editor and reviewers can locate the changes easily when reading the revised manuscript. `<text>` is typeset in red; with the `nocolorize` package option it is typeset in the normal text colour instead (useful when submitting a clean version without visible markup).

`\colorize` is also used internally by the `draft-heading` and `\footnotewithdetails` commands.

6 Citation Helpers (apacite)

These commands are active when `apacite` is loaded and the `nocitecommands` option is not given. If `apacite` is not loaded, basic fallbacks using `\cite` and `\citeauthor/\citeyear` are provided, and a package warning is issued.

Command	Example output	Use case
<code>\citeeg{⟨key⟩}</code>	(e.g., Smith 2020)	Cite an example reference
<code>\cites{⟨key⟩}</code>	Smith’s (2020)	Possessive citation in running text

7 Miscellaneous

7.1 `\includesubgraphics{⟨label⟩}{⟨filename⟩}`

Inserts a subfigure (via the `subcaption` package) at 90% of the text width, with a bold large label (e.g. **A**, **B**) but *without* a sub-caption. Use this when you want panel labels in a multi-panel figure but prefer a single shared caption below the whole figure rather than individual captions per panel.

```
\begin{figure}
  \includesubgraphics{A}{panel_a.pdf}
  \includesubgraphics{B}{panel_b.pdf}
  \caption{Results. Panel A shows ...; Panel B shows ...}
\end{figure}
```

7.2 `\protectedemail{⟨address⟩}`

Renders an email address in `typewriter` font inside a `tikz` node. Wrapping the address in a TikZ node rather than plain text prevents some simple web crawlers from harvesting it as a `mailto` target.

```
\protectedemail{ansgar.endress@gmx.net}
```

8 Backward Compatibility

An `ansgar.sty` shim is distributed alongside `psychtools`. It contains a single line:

```
\RequirePackage{psychtools}
```

Documents that used `\usepackage{ansgar}` continue to work without modification.

9 License

psychtools is distributed under the [LaTeX Project Public License](#), version 1.3c or later.

A Command and Option Reference

Package options

Option	Default	See
<code>includedetails</code>	on	§2
<code>excludedetails</code>	off	§2
<code>appendixtoc</code>	off	§2
<code>nocolorize</code>	off	§2
<code>nocitecommands</code>	off	§2

Commands

Command	See
<code>\T</code> , <code>\F</code> , <code>\Z</code> , <code>\p</code> , <code>\M</code>	§3
<code>\SD</code> , <code>\SE</code> , <code>\D</code> , <code>\CI</code>	§3
<code>\et</code> , <code>\etp</code> , <code>\U</code> , <code>\W</code>	§3
<code>\myappendix</code>	§4
<code>\appsection</code>	§4
<code>\appsectionFirst</code>	§4
<code>\appendixshortname</code>	§4
<code>\draftsection</code>	§5
<code>\draftsubsection</code>	§5
<code>\draftsubsubsection</code>	§5
<code>\footnotewithdetails</code>	§5
<code>\colorize</code>	§5
<code>\citeeg</code>	§6
<code>\cites</code>	§6
<code>\includesubgraphics</code>	§7
<code>\protectedemail</code>	§7

Index

`\appendixshortname`, 5
`appendixtoc` (option), 2
`\appsection`, 4
`\appsectionFirst`, 5

`\citeeg`, 6
`\cites`, 6
`\colorize`, 6

`\draftsection`, 5
`\draftsubsection`, 5
`\draftsubsubsection`, 5

`excludedetails` (option), 2

`\footnotewithdetails`, 6

`includedetails` (option), 2
`\includesubgraphics`, 6

`\myappendix`, 4

`nocitecommands` (option), 2
`nocolorize` (option), 2

`\protectedemail`, 7